

Pedro Castro

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PROFILE

Informatics and Computing Engineering student focused on backend engineering and infrastructure. Experienced with Kotlin/Spring Boot, Scala and Docker. Passionate about building reliable software, exploring new technologies, and working on challenging problems. Open-source supporter.

EDUCATION

Faculty of Engineering of the University of Porto Porto, Portugal
Bachelor in Informatics and Computing Engineering Sep 2022–Jul 2026
Relevant Coursework: Algorithms and Data Structures, Databases, Web Development, Operating Systems, Software Engineering, Distributed Systems, Computer Security, Compilers, Discrete Mathematics, Artificial Intelligence.

EXPERIENCE

NIAEFEUP Porto, Portugal
Co-Head of Projects May 2026–Present

- Coordinate and support multiple software projects across the student organization.
- Work with project managers on planning, communication, and delivery across all teams.
- Co-Head of Informatics for *Semana de Informática*, the organization's flagship annual tech event.

Project Manager Aug 2025–May 2026

- Led development of the association's website, coordinating a team of 15+ people across backend and frontend.
- Maintained and extended the association's backend (Kotlin, Spring Boot, PostgreSQL) and frontend (Svelte, Tailwind CSS).

Member Oct 2024–Present

- Contributor to *uni*, a Flutter app helping students organize academic life and schedules.
- Contributed to infrastructure for the organization's Kubernetes cluster (*niployments*).
- Member of the *SINF's* Competitions team, designing CTF challenges and programming contest problems.

Faculty of Engineering of the University of Porto Porto, Portugal
Teaching Assistant Feb 2026–Jun 2026

- Teaching assistant for the Computer Laboratory course (C device driver implementation in MINIX), supporting 40+ students with system programming and debugging.
- Held weekly lab sessions, explaining low-level systems concepts to students with varying experience levels.

Kevel Porto, Portugal
Engineering Intern Jul 2025

- Designed and built Scala tooling for CI pipelines to detect and report non-deterministic tests in large backend codebases, improving reliability and preventing flaky builds from reaching production.

PROJECTS

NixOS Configuration | *Nix, Linux, Infrastructure as Code* Present

- Built a declarative infrastructure-as-code system for managing multiple NixOS machines with a modular configuration.
- Deployed a home server running 15+ self-hosted services including media streaming, photo management, and file storage.
- Configured reverse proxy with automated SSL certificate management via Cloudflare DNS for remote access.

Personal Website/Portfolio | *Astro, Svelte, Tailwind CSS* Present

- Created a personal portfolio website to showcase projects, share blog posts, and host my resume.
- Built with Astro and Svelte and styled with Tailwind CSS.

DistributedChat | *Java, TLS, PostgreSQL, Distributed Systems* May 2026

- Built a TLS-secured distributed chat system with Java virtual threads, PostgreSQL persistence, and session tokens.
- Designed for fault tolerance with automatic retry, state preservation across disconnects, and integrated a local LLM (Ollama) for AI-powered responses in chat rooms.

OpenQuest | *Laravel, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, OpenAPI* Dec 2025

- Built a collaborative Q&A platform with a REST API documented in OpenAPI and role-based access control.
- Designed a PostgreSQL schema for questions, answers, voting, notifications, badges, and content moderation.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: C, C++, Java, Kotlin, Scala, Python, JavaScript, SQL, Dart, PHP, Nix
Backend: Spring Boot, NestJS, Laravel, REST APIs, OpenAPI
Databases: PostgreSQL, MongoDB, SQLite, MySQL, Database Design, Relational Algebra
DevOps & Tools: Git, Docker, CI/CD, Linux, Nix, Caddy
Frontend: Svelte, Astro, Tailwind CSS
Software Engineering: OOP, Design Patterns, Software Architecture, Unit Testing, Refactoring, Debugging

LANGUAGES

Portuguese: Native | **English:** Highly Proficient